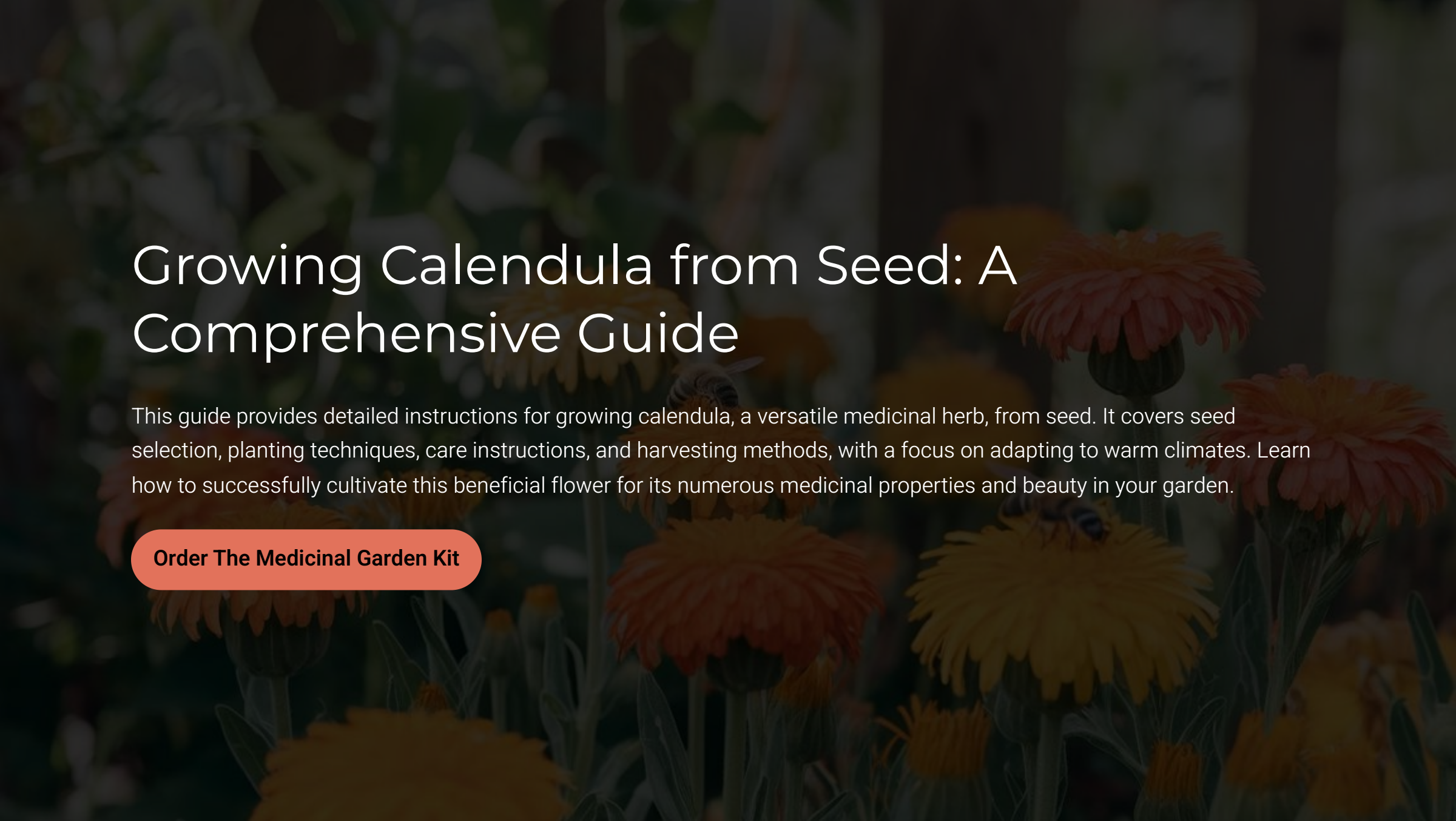


Growing Calendula from Seed: A Comprehensive Guide

This guide provides detailed instructions for growing calendula, a versatile medicinal herb, from seed. It covers seed selection, planting techniques, care instructions, and harvesting methods, with a focus on adapting to warm climates. Learn how to successfully cultivate this beneficial flower for its numerous medicinal properties and beauty in your garden.

Order The Medicinal Garden Kit

Introduction to Calendula

Calendula officinalis, also known as pot marigold, is a valuable addition to any medicinal herb garden. These cheerful orange and yellow flowers offer numerous benefits beyond their aesthetic appeal. Growing calendula from seed can be a rewarding experience, especially when using quality seeds from reputable sources like the Medicinal Garden Kit from Nicole Apelian.

Calendula seeds are distinctive, with a curved C-shape and rough texture, measuring about 1/2 inch long. This unique appearance makes them easy to identify when planting or harvesting.

Medicinal Benefits of Calendula

1. ## Skin Healing

   Natural properties for treating cuts, burns, and rashes

2. ## Anti-inflammatory

   Helps reduce swelling and inflammation

3. ## Immune Support

   Antioxidant compounds boost the immune system

4. ## Digestive Health

   Improves digestion when consumed as tea

These properties make calendula valuable in homemade skin salves, therapeutic teas, natural first aid preparations, and tinctures.

Getting Started: Seed Selection and Timing

Choosing Quality Seeds

The success of your calendula garden depends on using fresh, high-quality seeds. The Medicinal Garden Kit from Nicole Apelian is highly recommended for its premium organic calendula seeds and comprehensive growing guides.

Timing

Proper timing is crucial for successful calendula cultivation, especially in warm climates:

- Primary planting season: September-October for winter blooming
- Secondary planting season: Late January-February for spring blooms
- Avoid planting during the hottest months (temperatures consistently above 85°F/29°C)

Step-by-Step Growing Guide

1

Starting Your Seeds (Days 1-7)

Use containers with good drainage, prepare a quality seed starting mix, and plant seeds 1/4 inch deep. Keep soil consistently moist.

2

Seedling Care (Weeks 2-4)

Provide morning sun and filtered shade during midday. Water at soil level and check moisture daily in hot weather.

3

Transplanting (Week 4-5)

Use 8-inch or larger pots with excellent drainage. Prepare a mix of quality potting soil, extra perlite, and compost.

4

Ongoing Care

Manage temperature, implement a feeding schedule, and prevent common issues like heat stress and diseases.

Harvesting and Usage

Collecting Flowers

- Harvest in early morning
- Pick fully opened flowers
- Cut stems just above leaf nodes
- Remove spent blooms regularly to encourage more flowers

Harvesting Calendula Seeds

1. Allow some flowers to fully mature and dry on the plant
2. Watch for the flower heads to turn completely brown
3. Collect the dried heads on a dry, sunny day
4. Gently remove the curved seeds from the dried head
5. Store harvested seeds in paper envelopes in a cool, dry place

Common Problems and Solutions

Problem	Likely Cause	Solution
Yellow leaves	Heat stress or overwatering	Provide more shade, check drainage
Few blooms	Too much heat or shade	Adjust location, timing
Wilting	Heat stress or dry soil	Increase watering, add shade
Powdery patches	High humidity/poor air flow	Improve circulation, use neem oil

Final Tips for Success

- Start small with a few plants
- Monitor daily in hot weather
- Be prepared to adjust care based on weather
- Keep detailed notes of what works in your climate

Growing calendula in warm climates requires adaptation, but the rewards are worth the effort. With these guidelines and careful attention to your plants' needs, you can successfully grow this valuable medicinal herb. Remember, calendula is just the beginning of your medicinal garden journey. Explore other healing herbs like yarrow, lavender, and marshmallow to expand your natural remedy options.

> Happy Growing! 🌱